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LIGHTWEIGHT BUILDING ASSEMBLY

Abstract

A lightweight building assembly can include an insulation blanket, an insulation base, a frame, and tensioned elements. The insulation blanket can define an insulation blanket axis about which the insulation blanket can rotate. The insulation blanket can have a peripheral wall portion positioned at a varying radial distance from the insulation blanket axis. The insulation base can have a first membrane and can be coupled to and support the insulation blanket. The frame can have a second membrane and can be coupled to and support the insulation base. The frame can be configured to move with respect to the insulation base. The tensioned elements can be wound about the insulation blanket, and each tensioned element can extend tangentially from the peripheral wall portion to the second membrane. The tensioned elements can combine to form a continuous tension circuit across the assembly, which assembly can be effective in multiple disparate climates.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of and claims priority to U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/138,519, filed Apr. 24, 2023, which in turn claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/334,043, filed Apr. 22, 2022, both of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure relates generally to construction, and more particularly to building structure components and assemblies.

BACKGROUND

[0003] There are presently numerous challenges in the construction industry to provide building components and assemblies in a various applications and environments. In traditional construction practices, building structures are formed on site in layers of different materials. The types of materials used and the way that building layers are formed are typically based on the climate where a building is being constructed. Different environments and climate types can result in the need for entirely different types of building materials and construction techniques.

[0004] Unfortunately, this tends to result in a lack of flexibility with respect to any given set of building materials or components, as one set of building components may be suitable for an arid climate but not for a humid climate. Some climates may even require heavy and inflexible building materials. Furthermore, typical layered up construction techniques can be labor intensive, time consuming, and inflexible, with different sets of building components needing to be worked up on site to form a given structure. Although some forms of prefabricated building components do exist, these can be limited to certain environments and are not easily transported.

[0005] Although traditional ways of providing building structures have worked in the past, improvements are always helpful. In particular, what is desired are new building structures that are modular, flexible, lightweight, readily transportable, easily installed within an overall building structure, and configured to be used in any climate or environment.

SUMMARY

[0006] It is an advantage of the present disclosure to provide new building structures that are modular, flexible, lightweight, readily transportable, easily installed within an overall building structure, and configured to be used in any climate or environment. The disclosed features, apparatuses, systems, and methods provide lightweight building assemblies that can be used to form walls, roofs, floors, and other pertinent sections of an overall building structure. The foregoing advantages can be accomplished at least in part by lightweight building assemblies having insulation arrangements uniquely arranged within a structural framework, as well as tensioned elements that wrap around the assembly to hold the assembly together while allowing the assembly to be compressed, expanded, and flexibly arranged into a variety of shapes.

[0007] In various embodiments of the present disclosure, a lightweight building assembly can include an insulation blanket, an insulation base, a frame, and a plurality of tensioned elements. The insulation blanket can define an insulation blanket axis about which the insulation blanket is configured to rotate. Also, the insulation blanket can have a peripheral wall portion positioned at a radial distance from the insulation blanket axis, and the radial distance can vary along a length of the insulation blanket axis. The insulation base can be coupled to and configured to support the insulation blanket, and the insulation base can have a first membrane. The frame can be coupled to

and configured to support the insulation base, and the frame can have a second membrane. Also, the frame can be configured to move with respect to the insulation base. The plurality of tensioned elements can be situated about the insulation blanket, and each of the tensioned elements can extend tangentially from the peripheral wall portion of the insulation blanket to the second membrane. The plurality of tensioned elements can combine to form a continuous tension circuit across the lightweight building assembly.

[0008] In various detailed embodiments, the lightweight building assembly can be configured to be effective in multiple disparate climates. Such disparate climates can include an arid climate, a humid climate, a hot climate, a cold climate, and a hurricane zone. The insulation blanket can include an insulation material wrapped in a sealed membrane. The sealed membrane can be aluminum based in some arrangements. The insulation base can also include an insulation material wrapped in a sealed membrane, which sealed membrane can also be aluminum based. In various arrangements, the first membrane can be weatherproof and fire rated, and the second membrane can include a vapor opening and can be fire rated. The plurality of tensioned elements can be woven ratchet straps, among other possible materials, and can be coupled to the insulation base. In various embodiments, a first ventilation channel can be formed between the first membrane and the insulation blanket. In addition, a second ventilation channel can be formed between the second membrane and the insulation blanket.

[0009] In further embodiments of the present disclosure, various methods of operating a lightweight building assembly are provided. Pertinent process steps can include ventilating on either side of an insulation blanket, ventilating between a first membrane and the insulation blanket, and ventilating between a second membrane and the insulation blanket. The insulation blanket can be part of a lightweight building assembly that also includes at least an insulation base, a frame, and a plurality of tensioned elements. The insulation blanket can define an insulation blanket axis about which the insulation blanket is configured to rotate. Also, the insulation blanket can have a peripheral wall portion positioned at a radial distance from the insulation blanket axis, wherein the radial distance varies along a length of the insulation blanket axis. The insulation base can be coupled to and configured to support the insulation blanket, and the insulation base can have the first membrane. The frame can be coupled to and configured to support the insulation base, and the frame can have the second membrane. Also, the frame can be configured to move with respect to the insulation base. The plurality of tensioned elements can be wound about the insulation blanket, and each of the plurality of tensioned elements can extend tangentially from the peripheral wall portion of the insulation blanket to the second membrane.

[0010] In various detailed embodiments, one or more of the ventilating steps can involve the use of a fan, a wall shape, an airfoil, an electrical current, and/or any other suitable component or arrangement to facilitate airflow. Additional process steps can include using the insulation blanket, wherein the insulation blanket is insulated and airtight, providing a continuous tension circuit across the lightweight building assembly, and protecting the lightweight building assembly from external conditions.

[0011] In still further embodiments of the present disclosure, various methods of installing a lightweight building assembly are provided. Pertinent process steps can include providing an insulation blanket, coupling an insulation base having a first membrane to the insulation blanket, coupling a frame to the insulation base, installing a plurality of tensioned elements, and installing a second membrane to the frame. The insulation blanket can define an insulation blanket axis about which the insulation blanket is configured to rotate. Also, the insulation blanket can have a peripheral wall portion positioned at a radial distance from the insulation blanket axis, and the radial distance can be configured to vary along a length of the insulation blanket axis. The frame can be coupled to the insulation base such that the frame is configured to move with respect to the insulation base. The plurality of tensioned elements can be installed about the insulation blanket such that each of the plurality of tensioned elements extends tangentially from the peripheral

wall portion of the insulation blanket. The second membrane can be installed to the frame such that the second membrane is at a distance above a floor of the overall building structure.

[0012] In various detailed embodiments, the plurality of tensioned elements can combine to form a continuous tension circuit across the lightweight building assembly. Installing the plurality of tensioned elements can involve coupling the tensioned elements to the insulation base. Also, the lightweight building assembly can be configured to be effective in multiple disparate climates. In some arrangements, an additional process step can involve rotating the insulation blanket about an insulation blanket axis.

[0013] Other apparatuses, methods, features, and advantages of the disclosure will be or will become apparent to one with skill in the art upon examination of the following figures and detailed description. It is intended that all such additional apparatuses, methods, features and advantages be included within this description, be within the scope of the disclosure, and be protected by the accompanying claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0014] The included drawings are for illustrative purposes and serve only to provide examples of possible structures and arrangements for the disclosed apparatuses, systems and methods of use regarding lightweight building assemblies. These drawings in no way limit any changes in form and detail that may be made to the disclosure by one skilled in the art without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure.

[0015] FIG. 1 illustrates in side cross-section view an example overall building structure having a lightweight building assembly within a wall region according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0016] FIG. 2 illustrates in perspective cross-section view an example wall region of the overall structure of FIG. 1 according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0017] FIG. 3 illustrates in side cross-section view the wall region of FIG. 2 according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0018] FIG. 4 illustrates in side cross-section view an example overall building structure having a lightweight building assembly within a roof region according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0019] FIG. 5 illustrates in side cross-section view an example roof region of the overall structure of FIG. 4 according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0020] FIG. 6 illustrates a flowchart of an example method of operating a lightweight building assembly according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0021] FIG. 7 illustrates a flowchart of an example method of installing a lightweight building assembly according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0022] Exemplary applications of apparatuses, systems, and methods according to the present disclosure are described in this section. These examples are being provided solely to add context and aid in the understanding of the disclosure. It will thus be apparent to one skilled in the art that the present disclosure may be practiced without some or all of these specific details provided herein. In some instances, well known process steps have not been described in detail in order to avoid unnecessarily obscuring the present disclosure. Other applications are possible, such that the following examples should not be taken as limiting. In the following detailed description, references are made to the accompanying drawings, which form a part of the description and in which are shown, by way of illustration, specific embodiments of the present disclosure. Although these embodiments are described in sufficient detail to enable one skilled in the art to practice the

disclosure, it is understood that these examples are not limiting, such that other embodiments may be used, and changes may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure. [0023] The present disclosure relates in various embodiments to features, apparatuses, systems, and methods for lightweight building assemblies. The disclosed embodiments generally provide easy to deploy well insulated building structures that are climate dominant in that they can operate effectively in a variety of disparate climates. The disclosed structures are lightweight, strong, reliable, and thermally advantageous assemblies for overall building structures. The disclosed structures can also be readily transported and are flexible such that they can be installed into overall building structures in a variety of shapes and configurations.

[0024] These advantages can be accomplished at least in part by providing an insulation blanket within one or more membranes, tensioned elements, an insulation base, and a frame, among other components. The insulation blanket and membrane combination can act as a thermal, air, and moisture barrier in any climate or environment. The tensioned elements can be wound along an axis of the insulation blanket that is located at a varying distance radially outward from the insulation blanket. These tensioned elements can form a continuous envelope circuit around the structure that provides structural rigidity to the lightweight building assembly while also providing the assembly with the flexibility to allow installation in a variety of different shapes. An insulation base coupled to the insulation blanket can include membranes and a frame to support the insulation blanket in some arrangements.

[0025] Although various embodiments disclosed herein discuss the provided lightweight building assemblies as wall and roof assemblies for a dwelling for purposes of illustration, it will be readily appreciated that the disclosed features, apparatuses, systems, and methods can similarly be used for other purposes as may be desired. For example, the disclosed embodiments may also be arranged to form all or parts of ceilings, floors, doors, partitions, and other structural components. In addition to dwellings, the disclosure lightweight building assemblies can also be used for offices, retail shops, warehouses, and other types of buildings. Other applications, arrangements, and extrapolations beyond the illustrated embodiments are also contemplated.

[0026] Referring first to FIG. 1, an example overall building structure having a lightweight building assembly within a wall region is illustrated in side cross-section view. Overall building structure **10** can include various well-known structural features, such as, for example, a floor **12**, a roof **14**, one or more doors **16**, and an outside porch **18** or other structure abutting element, among other possible structural features. Overall building structure **10** can also include one or more walls **100** or wall regions. Such walls **100** or wall regions can be integrally formed with the roof **14** in some arrangements. Wall **100** is shown within highlighted region **50**, which will be discussed in greater detail below with respect to FIGS. 2 and 3.

[0027] Continuing with FIGS. 2 and 3, an example wall region of the overall building structure of FIG. 1 is shown in perspective cross-section and side cross-section views respectively. The example wall region as shown is a floor to wall section that can represent an off the grid housing topology, for example, and can leverage advanced materials to achieve a climate dominant performance. That is, the disclosed structure can be used effectively in virtually any type of climate, such as an arid climate, a humid climate, a hurricane zone, hot, cold, or any other extreme climate on earth or any other location. Again, the overall building structure can include a variety of well-known structural elements, such as, for example, a floor **12**, subfloor **11**, foundational elements **13**, and a subfloor support beam **15**, among other basic structural elements. At least a portion of wall **100** can include a lightweight building assembly that is modular, flexible, compressible, expandable, readily transportable, and readily installable into an overall building structure.

[0028] Various components of the lightweight building assembly can include frame **110** and insulation base **112**, which together provide an overall structural framework for the lightweight building assembly. Frame **110** can provide the primary structural support for the assembly and can

facilitate integration of the assembly into an overall building structure. In various embodiments, frame **110** can be formed from a lightweight but rigid wood, composite, or metal material, for example, although other materials can alternatively be used. Insulation base **112** can couple to frame **110** and can be used to support other structural components within the assembly. In various embodiments, insulation base **112** can include spaced apart blocks having end caps to facilitate structural connections and rigidity. Various assembly components can then attach to the end caps of insulation base **112**. Insulation base **112** can also be formed from a lightweight but rigid wood, composite, or metal material, for example. In a particular non-limiting example, the blocks of insulation base **112** can be formed of a plywood material with an insulated core, while the endcaps can be formed of a nylon material.

[0029] Peripheral wall portion **114** can be the outermost portions of the wall visible on the outside of the structure. Peripheral wall portion **114** can be an exterior rain barrier formed of a high performance textile material, and can be fabric, cloth, plastic, or any other suitable material. Together, frame **110**, insulation base **112**, and peripheral wall portion **114** can combine to form internal framework and outside surface elements of the lightweight building assembly. First membrane **116** can be a membrane disposed between peripheral wall portion **114** and insulation base **112** at an exterior region of the lightweight building assembly, while second membrane **118** can be a membrane disposed between peripheral wall portion **114** and insulation base **112** at an exterior region of the lightweight building assembly. In various arrangements, an offset **117** can be formed between the bottom of second membrane **118** and the ground or floor of the overall building structure. Such an offset **117** can function to limit dirt or debris from accumulating on second membrane **118**. Offset **117** can be about two to three feet, although other distances are also possible.

[0030] The lightweight building assembly can also include an arrangement of insulation components located within this structure formed by frame **110**, insulation base **112**, and peripheral wall portion **114**. Insulation blanket **120** can have insulation material **122** sealed inside insulation blanket membrane **124**. Insulation material **122** can be fiberglass, aerogel, or any other suitable insulation material, for example. Insulation blanket membrane **124**, which encloses insulation material **122** inside insulation blanket **120**, can be a nonpermeable airtight and moisture resistant membrane formed of any suitable material, such as a sheet material. Insulation blanket membrane **124** can be coated in aluminum or another suitable material such that it wicks moisture away from the insulation blanket. In a particular non-limiting example, insulation blanket membrane **124** can be an Airshield or Henry membrane.

[0031] In various embodiments, insulation blanket **120** having insulation material **122** inside blanket membrane **124** can be a preassembled unit that can be installed together within the lightweight building assembly. For example, frame **110** and insulation base **112** can be formed to provide an overall structure for the lightweight building assembly, and then insulation blanket **120** can be installed as a preformed component within the frame and insulation base. Insulation blanket **120** can attach to the blocks of insulation base **112**, for example.

[0032] Insulation blanket **120** can define an insulation blanket axis **119** about which the insulation blanket is configured to rotate. The insulation blanket, which can also include the peripheral wall portion **114**, can be positioned at a radial distance from the insulation blanket axis **119**. Depending on the overall shape formed by the installed insulation blanket **120**, the radial distance can vary along a length of the insulation blanket axis **119**.

[0033] After insulation blanket **120** is installed, a plurality of tensioned elements **130** can then be installed around the insulation blanket by coupling the tensioned elements to insulation base **112**. Insulation blanket **120** can be flexible, such that it can be formed into any desired shape. This plurality of tensioned elements **130** can allow the lightweight building assembly to be compressed to facilitate easy transport and expanded during construction to form a wall portion, roof portion, or other building component. Tensioned elements **130** are also flexible so to facilitate the ability to

shape insulation blanket **120** therewith and form the overall lightweight building assembly into a variety of different shapes, such as curved, straight, or other shapes. The plurality of tensioned elements **130** can combine to form a continuous tension circuit **132** across the lightweight building assembly. Such a continuous tension circuit **132** can function to hold insulation blanket **120** in place within the lightweight building assembly.

[0034] Tensioned elements **130** can be formed of any suitable lightweight, strong, and flexible material, such as, for example, fabric, plastic, rubber, or the like. In a particular non-limiting example, tensioned elements **130** can be fabric ratchet straps. A flexible material is preferable over rigid poles or similar structural materials in order to provide greater flexibility and lighter weight. In various arrangements, the plurality of tensioned elements **130** can be attached to the blocks of insulation base **112** to form a woven grid on the inside and outside of the insulation system so that it can take on any shape. This combination of components can function similar to a corset system in that tensioned elements **130** can be loose or saggy prior to and during installation, and tension can then be applied to tighten the system and provide an overall desired shape to the lightweight building assembly.

[0035] When installed, the lightweight building assembly can include one or more ventilation channels that provide airflow about the assembly. For example, a first ventilation channel **113** toward the exterior of the lightweight building assembly can provide airflow between first membrane **116** and insulation blanket **120**. Similarly, a second ventilation channel **115** toward the interior of the lightweight building assembly can provide airflow between second membrane **118** and insulation blanket **120**. Additional ventilation or airflow channels are also possible. Ventilation channels can form a gap or passage of about 8 inches in some arrangements, although other dimensions are also possible. Airflow channels **113**, **115** can facilitate an even thermal distribution across the lightweight building assembly by passing air therethrough and transferring heat away from any localized hotspots. In various arrangements, airflow through ventilation channels **113**, **115** can be facilitated by one or more fans, wall shapes, airfoils, electrical currents and/or other suitable devices to draw or push air through the channels.

[0036] In various embodiments, some or all of the foregoing materials in the disclosed lightweight building assembly can be fire rated, such as at a class A, M1, or M0 designation. Some or all of the membranes and other components can also be hurricane or wind resistant at wind speeds of up to 130 mph or more. In addition to the foregoing components disclosed for a modular and readily portable and installable lightweight building assembly, other components may also be included. For example, sensors can be installed within the assembly to measure building performance in a variety of ways. One or more processors may also be included in conjunction with such sensors to detect assembly issues and provide warnings or alerts. Other types of components are also possible, as will be readily appreciated.

[0037] Turning next to FIG. 4, an example overall building structure having a lightweight building assembly within a roof region is illustrated in side cross-section view. Similar to the foregoing example, overall building structure **20** can include various well-known structural features, such as, for example, a floor **22**, a one or more walls **24**, one or more doors **26**, and an outside porch **28** or other similar element, among other structural features. Overall building structure **20** can also include one or more roofs **200** or roof regions. Such roofs **200** or roof regions can be integrally formed with one or more walls in some arrangements. Roof **200** is shown within highlighted region **60**, which will be discussed in greater detail below with respect to FIG. 5.

[0038] Continuing with FIG. 5 an example roof region of the overall structure of FIG. 4 is shown in side cross-section view. As shown, roof region **200** can be arranged atop an overall building structure such that there is a building exterior region **201** and a building interior region **202**. In various arrangements, one or more roof regions **200** can be integrally formed with one or more wall regions to form a combined roof and wall lightweight building assembly

[0039] Similar to wall region **100** above, roof region **200** can form a lightweight building assembly

having many of the same or similar components. Roof region **200** can include, for example, frame **210**, insulation base **212**, and insulation blanket **220**, which can similarly have insulation material sealed inside insulation blanket membrane. Insulation blanket **220** can define an insulation blanket axis **219** about which the insulation blanket is configured to rotate. First membrane **216** can be disposed at an exterior region of the lightweight building assembly, while second membrane **218** can be disposed at an interior region of the lightweight building assembly. A plurality of tensioned elements **230** can couple to insulation base **212** and can function to hold insulation blanket **220** in place and provide overall rigidity, structure, and shape to the lightweight building assembly. Similar ventilation channels can provide airflow about the assembly, and can include, for example, a first ventilation channel **213** toward the exterior of the lightweight building assembly and a second ventilation channel **215** toward the interior of the lightweight building assembly, as shown. Additional components can include a protective tape **240** on frame **210**, and structural bracing **242** between frame elements.

[0040] FIG. **6** illustrates a flowchart of an example method of operating a lightweight building assembly. In various embodiments, method **600** can be applied using the various systems, devices, and features provided above. After a start step **602**, a first process step **604** can involve using an insulation blanket that is insulated and airtight. This can involve having an insulation blanket having a membrane and/or other suitable component or components that surround the insulation blanket and form an airtight seal around the insulation blanket. Leveraging the use of a sealed and airtight insulation blanket can facilitate a better performance of one or more of the following steps, such as the following ventilation steps.

[0041] At the next process step **606**, ventilating can take place on either side of an insulation blanket within the lightweight building assembly. This can involve providing an airflow along one or both sides of the insulation blanket.

[0042] At the next process step **608**, ventilating can take place between a first membrane of the lightweight building assembly and the insulation blanket. As detailed above, the first membrane can be disposed at an exterior region of the lightweight building assembly, such that ventilating step **606** can involve providing an airflow along an exterior region of the insulation blanket and overall lightweight building assembly.

[0043] At the next process step **610**, ventilating can take place between a second membrane of the lightweight building assembly and the insulation blanket. Again, the second membrane can be located at an interior region of the lightweight building assembly, such that ventilating step **608** can involve providing an airflow along an interior region of the insulation blanket and overall lightweight building assembly.

[0044] At the next process step **612**, a continuous tension circuit can be provided across the lightweight building assembly. This can involve a plurality of tensioned members coupled to an insulation base of the assembly and pulled tight to provide the tension.

[0045] At the next process step **614**, the lightweight building assembly can be protected from various external conditions. Such conditions external to the lightweight building assembly can include conditions and elements both outside and inside the building structure of which the assembly is a part. For example, moisture can be wicked away from one or membranes of the lightweight building assembly, which can include the first and second membranes. This can be accomplished through the use of a nonpermeable material for the membranes, which can be coated with a material to facilitate moisture wicking. Such a material can be aluminum based, for example, although other materials can also be used. Such moisture wicking can take place at one or more membranes and involve moisture at one or more surfaces both inside and outside the lightweight building assembly and associated building structure.

[0046] Another example of protecting against external conditions can involve protecting the lightweight building assembly from things outside the lightweight building assembly and associated building structure, such as heat, cold, rain, wind, other weather conditions and other

external items that may be damaging to the assembly. Other features and functions of the lightweight building assembly as disclosed herein can also be part of the step of protecting against external conditions. The method then ends at end step **616**.

[0047] It will be appreciated that the foregoing method **600** may include additional steps not shown, and that not all steps are necessary in some embodiments. For example, additional steps may include the use of sensors to monitor and detect building performance and conditions, among other possible steps. Furthermore, the order of steps may be altered as desired, and one or more steps may be performed simultaneously. For example, all of process steps **604-614** can be performed simultaneously, and can be continuously performed. Other process steps, details, and arrangements are also possible.

[0048] Lastly, FIG. 7 illustrates a flowchart of an example method of installing a lightweight building assembly. In various embodiments, method **700** can be applied using the various systems, devices, and features provided above. After a start step **702**, a first process step **704** can involve providing an insulation blanket. Such an insulation blanket can be a preformed structure having an insulation material sealed within a nonpermeable membrane for example. Other details regarding this insulation blanket are provided above.

[0049] At the next process step **706**, the insulation blanket can be rotated about an insulation blanket axis. This can be done to shape the insulation blanket into a variety of different shapes, such as a straight shape or a parabolic or other curved shape, as noted above. Such a shape can then form the basis of the overall shape of the lightweight building structure.

[0050] At a following process step **708**, an insulation base can be coupled to the insulation blanket. This can involve fastening the insulation blanket to blocks or other suitable components of the insulation base. The insulation base can have a first membrane that is nonpermeable to prevent moisture from passing therethrough.

[0051] At the next process step **710**, a frame can be coupled to the insulation base. Such a frame can provide an overall structure for the lightweight building assembly that all assembly components are contained within or about.

[0052] At a following process step **712**, a plurality of tensioned elements can be installed about the insulation blanket. This can involve fastening or otherwise coupling the tensioned elements to the insulation base, such as at blocks of the insulation base. The tensioned elements can have slack or otherwise be loose upon initial coupling and can then be pulled tight to provide tension across the lightweight building assembly, similar to a corset arrangement.

[0053] At subsequent process step **714**, a second membrane can be installed to the frame. This second membrane can cover the insulation blanket and tensioned elements to provide an aesthetically pleasing surface to the interior region of the lightweight building assembly. The method then ends at end step **716**.

[0054] It will be appreciated that the foregoing method **700** may include additional steps not shown, and that not all steps are necessary in some embodiments. For example, additional steps may include compressing or expanding the lightweight building assembly using the tensioned elements. Other process steps can involve shaping the lightweight building assembly, such as in a straight line or along any of a variety of curves. Also, the order of steps may be altered as desired, and one or more steps may be performed simultaneously. For example, step **708** may be performed prior to steps **704** and **706**. As another example, one or more of process steps **704-708** can be performed simultaneously. Other process steps, details, and arrangements as will be readily appreciated.

[0055] Although the foregoing disclosure has been described in detail by way of illustration and example for purposes of clarity and understanding, it will be recognized that the above described disclosure may be embodied in numerous other specific variations and embodiments without departing from the spirit or essential characteristics of the disclosure. Certain changes and

modifications may be practiced, and it is understood that the disclosure is not to be limited by the foregoing details, but rather is to be defined by the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A system, comprising: an insulation blanket defining an insulation blanket axis about which the insulation blanket is configured to rotate, the insulation blanket having a peripheral wall portion positioned at a distance from the insulation blanket axis; an insulation base coupled to and configured to support the insulation blanket, the insulation base having a first membrane; and a plurality of tensioned elements situated about the insulation blanket, wherein each of the plurality of tensioned elements extends tangentially from the peripheral wall portion of the insulation blanket, and wherein the plurality of tensioned elements combine to form a continuous tension circuit across the system.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein the insulation blanket includes an insulation material contained within a sealed membrane.
3. The system of claim 2, wherein the insulation blanket is vacuum sealed.
4. The system of claim 1, wherein the insulation blanket includes an aerogel material.
5. The system of claim 1, wherein the system is configured to be a lightweight building assembly.
6. The system of claim 1, wherein the system is configured to be effective in multiple disparate climates.
7. The system of claim 6, wherein the multiple disparate climates include an arid climate, a humid climate, a hot climate, a cold climate, and hurricane zone.
8. The system of claim 1, wherein the insulation blanket is sealed with an aluminum based membrane.
9. The system of claim 1, wherein the first and second membranes are laminated to the insulation blanket.
10. The system of claim 1, wherein the system is configured to wick moisture away from the insulation blanket.
11. The system of claim 10, further comprising: a first ventilation channel formed between the first membrane and the insulation blanket, the first ventilation channel configured to wick moisture away from the insulation blanket.
12. The system of claim 11, further comprising: a second ventilation channel formed between the second membrane and the insulation blanket, the second ventilation channel configured to wick moisture away from the insulation blanket.
13. The system of claim 1, wherein the second membrane includes a vapor opening.
14. The system of claim 1, wherein the first membrane is fireproof and fire rated.
15. The system of claim 1, wherein the system is configured to be compressed to facilitate transport and to be expanded during construction.
16. The system of claim 1, wherein the system is configured to house mechanical, electrical, and plumbing conduits.
17. The system of claim 1, wherein the system is configured to be readily installable to an existing overall building structure.
18. A lightweight building assembly, comprising: an insulation blanket defining an insulation blanket axis about which the insulation blanket is positioned, the insulation blanket having a peripheral wall portion positioned at a distance from the insulation blanket axis; an insulation base coupled to and configured to support the insulation blanket, the insulation base having a first membrane; a frame coupled to and configured to support the insulation base, the frame having a second membrane; and a plurality of tensioned elements situated about the insulation blanket, wherein each of the plurality of tensioned elements extends tangentially from the peripheral wall portion of the insulation blanket to the second membrane, and wherein the plurality of tensioned

elements combine to form a continuous tension circuit across the lightweight building assembly.

19. The lightweight building assembly of claim 18, wherein the insulation blanket includes an insulation material contained within a sealed membrane, and wherein the insulation blanket is vacuum sealed and includes an aerogel material.

20. A building assembly, comprising: an insulation blanket including an insulation material contained within a sealed membrane, wherein the insulation blanket is vacuum sealed and includes an aerogel material; an insulation base coupled to and configured to support the insulation blanket, the insulation base having a first membrane; and a plurality of tensioned elements situated about the insulation blanket, wherein the plurality of tensioned elements combine to form a continuous tension circuit across the building assembly.
